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Megadeals propel M&A activity

M&A | Strategy

March 24, 2026 - After dealmaking slowed momentarily in early 2025, global M&A activity quickly assumed a grand scale—delivering big gains for the year. All this week, we explore M&A trends, from megadeals to cross-regional trading and more.

Global M&A activity soared in late 2025, with total deal value surging roughly 43 percent over the prior year, to about $4.7 trillion, despite the number of deals remaining flat. The increase in deal value was driven by a higher share of transactions exceeding $10 billion, signaling a shift toward larger, more strategic deals, McKinsey Senior Partners Jake Henry and Mieke Van Oostende note. Regionally, the Americas led the recovery with concentrated high-value dealmaking, Asia–Pacific saw a moderate rebound supported by cross-regional deals, and Europe, the Middle East, and Africa experienced more mixed momentum amid structural changes. Click through the interactive to see more.

Globally, M&A activity increased 43 percent in 2025.

Global M&A deals in 2020–25[1]

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[1]Announced deals not withdrawn or canceled. Unless otherwise noted, deal values reported are enterprise values. Data on deals valued >$25 million, including spin- and split-off transactions. Data also include private-placement transactions >$100 million.
[2]"Total market value" refers to the average sum of market capitalizations of all constituent companies in the Global Equity Indices.
Source: Datastream by London Stock Exchange, accessed January 2026; PitchBook, accessed January 2026; S&P Capital IQ, S&P Global Market Intelligence, accessed January 2026; McKinsey analysis

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To read the report, see "2026 M&A trends: Navigating a rapidly rebounding market," February 13, 2026.